

July 2024 Scotland 37th Birthday Trip Itinerary

Thursday, 7/4: DFW > LHR

- Flight 820 from DFW to JFK at 8:29am
 - Arrives at 1:28pm in Terminal 8
 - Go to a lounge or two in JFK
 - Terminal 8 -- AA & British Airways Soho Lounge – beautiful, access for exec platinum, GF food options (can also get into Chelsea I think, but lower class?)
 - Terminal 8 -- AA Flagship (?) Lounge (outdated)
- Flight 100 from JFK to LHR at 6:10pm
 - Arrives on 7/5 at 6:20am in Terminal 3 (LHR > Glasgow departs out of Terminal 5)

Friday, 7/5: LHR > Glasgow

- Arrive in LHR at 6:20am in Terminal 3 - Go to Terminal 5 for LHR > Glasgow
 - Lounge in Terminal 5 to take quick shower? Club Aspire Lounge in Terminal 5A south
- Flight 6740 from LHR to GLA at 8:20am from Terminal 5
 - Arrives at 9:45am
- Drop bags or check-in to Hotel - Z Hotel Glasgow
 - Right next to Queens Street Station
- Lunch at Bella Italia? Kinda close to hotel
- Walking tour at 2pm or 5pm - already booked for \$12
 - <https://walkingtoursin.com/scotland-tours/glasgow/glasgow-tours/glasgow-city-centre-walking-tour/>
 - Meeting Point: Outside Glasgow City Chambers, George Square
- Spain vs Germany game at 5pm, other quarterfinal at 8pm
- Dinner at Bella Italia - have a reservation for 5:30pm

Saturday, 7/6: Glasgow

- Mural trail
 - There's a map to see all, probably takes 1 hr 30 min
- Temple Gasometers
- Buchanan street (shopping)
- Glasgow cathedral
- Lots of options for lunch from pancakes to pizza to burgers
- England vs Switzerland at 5pm, other quarterfinal at 8pm
- Dinner at Red Onion
 - Open from 12-9pm
 - Made a reservation at 7:15pm
 - <https://www.red-onion.co.uk/gluten-free-la-carte-menu/>
- Get snacks for the train

Sunday, 7/7: Glasgow > Fort William

- Go for a run in Queen's Park
- Late breakfast/coffee in Glasgow at Stack & Still? GF sweet or savory pancakes and opens at 9am and also have lattes and things.
- Checkout at 11am
- Train to Fort William at 12:20pm from Queen Street Station
 - Have tickets booked
 - Seat 15A
 - Arrive in Fort William at 4:09pm
- Check-in to Hotel - Fort William Nevis Bank Inn
- Go to Lidl to get food for the hike tomorrow - open from 8am to 8pm Sundays (or go tomorrow morning before - open at 8am again)
- Dinner at the hotel restaurant looks so good and tons of GF options marked
 - Hours per TripAdvisor are 12:00 PM - 2:30 PM; 5:30 PM - 9:30 PM all days - have to call for reservations
 - OR Crannog Garrison West (seafood). It's open 7 days; Lunch from 12-2:30pm Dinner from 5-pm

Monday, 7/8: Fort William

- Ben Nevis Hike (could take anywhere between 5-10 hrs roundtrip)
 - Highest mountain in the UK
 - 1.4 mile walk to the Ben Nevis Visitor Centre (start of hike) OR there could be buses, but I can't figure it out online
 - Pack a lunch
- Nevis Laundry - open 9-5 M-F but doesn't look like self-service is available
- Dinner at The Geographer - owner is Celiac and it looks amazing with GF calamari, mussels, etc (18 min walk from hotel). Doesn't take reservations in the summer and closed on Sunday and only open from 5-9pm Monday

Tuesday, 7/9: Fort William > Mallaig > Armadale > Portree

- Train from Fort William to Mallaig on ScotRail at 8:15am
 - Have tickets booked — there were no seats available on the Jacobite Steam Train
 - Arrives in Mallaig at 9:38pm
 - Cannot hop off at the Glenfinnan Viaduct because the next train doesn't come until 12:30 and I'd miss the ferry
- Ferry on Caledonian MacBrayne from Mallaig to Armadale at 12:45pm
 - Have tickets booked at 12:45pm and 2:45pm
 - Arrives at 1:30pm or 3:45pm
- Catch bus 52 to Portree in Armadale at 3:02pm.
 - Cityline Scotland (app) saying to take 52 all the way to Portree Somerled Square arriving at 4:15pm

- Google Maps saying to take this bus 25 min (21 stops) to Post Office and arrives at 3:30pm. Then change to bus 917 to Portree at 3:46pm. Goes 43 min (10 stops) and ends in Somerled Square in Portree at 4:29pm. Then it's a ~1 mile walk to the hotel. (But I think I could get off 1-2 stops early and it might be closer to the hotel)
 - Could take a taxi if needed, but need to book in advance and it would be like \$300
- Check-in to Hotel: Bracken Hide Hotel in Portree
- Dinner - booked a spot at the bar at Antler's at 5:45pm - had to provide card details to book - \$20 to cancel
- Euros 2024 Semi at 8pm - Macnab's Inn at the Royal Hotel has live sports on at the bar and maybe Antler's does too

Portree Restaurant Options:

- *Cuillins Hills Hotel Restaurant: <https://cuillinhills-hotel-skye.co.uk>:*
 - *Lunch M-Sa 12-3pm: mussels, GF bread, fish & chips, salads, etc (Def go for lunch one day)*
 - *Grazing 12-9pm in bar & on lawn (no booking required): sharing boards & snacks, but GF not marked so not sure <https://www.cuillinhills-hotel-skye.co.uk/Menus/grazing-menu.pdf>*
 - *Dinner 5:30 - 9pm booking required: looks okay - salmon, seafood platter for 2: <https://www.cuillinhills-hotel-skye.co.uk/Menus/dinner-menu.pdf>*
- *Dulse and Brose: <https://perlehotels.com/wp-content/uploads/2023/06/Dulse-Brose-Menu-2023-June.pdf>*
 - *Dinner: only open for dinner — salmon, fish & chips*
- *Antlers (in The Portree Hotel): <https://theportreehotel.com/food-and-drink>*
 - *Lunch: from 12-2pm*
<https://theportreehotel.com/pdf/73732d67698b79100fdced1e4b0446fe.pdf>
 - *They pack lunches too!*
 - *Dinner: from 5-9pm*
<https://theportreehotel.com/pdf/3e4b47906e91647ac77c66f998a6cbb0.pdf>
- *Chargrill*
 - *Dinner only? Looks INSANE good with lobster, scallops, etc.*
 - *Also have a patio/courtyard menu that looks really, really good too. Not sure what the times are for it.*
- *Frasers (at Bracken Hide Hotel):*
 - *Dinner: only open for dinner daily from 5:30-9:30pm. Gnocchi, salmon, and risotto*
- *Relish: open 8:30am-4pm.*
 - *Breakfast: Has lattes and maybe GF bread for breakfast*
 - *Lunch: Maybe GF sandwiches*
- *Cafe Arriba: Open daily from 8am-4pm. Menu changes daily*
 - *Breakfast: apparently has a GF breakfast*

- Lunch: Might have GF bread for sandwiches
- An Talla Mòr Eighteen Twenty
 - Lunch

Can use for transport in Portree:

- <https://www.stagecoachbus.com/> (one of the bus options available)
- <https://skye-taxis.co.uk/private-hire.html>
- BWS Taxis in Portree - really good reviews about Brian who owns the place

Wednesday, 7/10: Portree, Isle of Skye

- Quiraing Walk! Take bus 57A from Somerled Square. First bus looks like it leaves at 6:55am. Will take about 40min to Flodigarry road end. Then need to walk ~10min down to the Flodigarry hike parking lot and then walk to the loop. It will be about 11km and take 4-5.5 hours
 - Bus on the return comes at 11:25am or 12:54pm (or 2:35pm)
- Wander around town
 - Climb the Apothecary's Tower at The Lump
- Laundry: self-serve at Portree Independent Hostel from 9am-10pm OR Skye Laundry offers pick-up and drop-off full-service for \$20 a load
- Dinner at 6:15pm at Chargrill - made a reservation
- Euros 2024 Semi at 8pm

Thursday, 7/11: Portree, Isle of Skye

Not booking anything to see what I want to do:

- Keep walking around Skye?
- Stardust boat trip?
- Sligachan Old Bridge (15 min bus ride)
 - 12 min bus ride to Highland Cows viewpoint parking lot
 - Take the ferry to Raasay island and the distillery (have gin!) - Ferry takes ~30min
- Bike tour??? Rent one here: <https://www.bikesonthebrae.com/about-us> - Storr, Bride Veils Waterfall, etc within 40 min ride (also avail via bus)
- Get food for the tour tomorrow
- Jackson Wholefoods has GF
- Lunch
- Dinner - try for HOTEL or Dulce and Brose (neither have reservations available)

Friday, 7/12: Portree, Isle of Skye

- Skye in a Day! Meet at Portree Visit Scotland Tourist Information (I-Centre) Car Park for departure at 8.45am
 - Driver will be in a black Ford Minibus with Skye Scenic Tours written on the front and back of the vehicle in white lettering so please make yourself known to him when you arrive.

- Remember to bring a packed lunch with you onto the tour as there is no cafe/shop stop at lunchtime
- Here is a map showing your route from The Bracken Hide Hotel to our pick up point (as you can see there is a Co-op Food Shop nearby where you can purchase prepacked sandwiches, salads, pastries, fruit, drinks etc. and any other supplies you will need for the day: Bracken Hide Hotel to VisitScotland Portree iCentre - Google Maps
- <https://www.viator.com/tours/Scotland/DAY-TOURS-OF-SKYE-FROM-PORTREE-VISITING-THE-MOST-SCENIC-SPOTS/d732-26663P2> (not Viator anymore - booked on website...check gmail)
- 2.5 mile walk to Fairy Pools
- Neist Point
- Dunvegan Castle
- Fairy Glen
- Quiraing Walk (25 min)
- Kilt Rock
- Old Man of Storr (just quick photo stop)
- Dinner at The Cuillins Hills Hotel at 7pm; reservation booked and required card for deposit
- Get snacks for the bus ride tomorrow

Saturday, 7/13: Isle of Skye to Inverness

- Scottish CityLink bus from Portree to Inverness at 9am
 - From Portree Square to Inverness Bus Station, arrives at 12:20pm
- Drop luggage &/or check-in to hotel: Royal Highland Hotel quickly
- Inverness Highland Games Day 2024
 - From 10:30 AM - 6:00 PM
 - <https://invernesshighlandgames.com/>
 - At Bught Park -- 1.2km (25 min) walk from hotel
 - Bought tix already
- Victorian Market open 8am-8pm daily (right near the hotel)
- Dinner at Prime at 7:30pm - have reservation on OpenTable. Took card to book so might have to pay to cancel. Menu looks incredible and has GF marked.

Sunday, 7/14: Inverness

- Run/coffee
- Daytrip to Loch Ness:
 - Can either take a bus to Dochgarroch Locks OR rent a bike at ticket to ride and ride a bike there (25 min)
 - Sightseeing bus is only \$12 and goes to Dochgarroch Loch <https://www.citysightseeinginverness.com/> but not until after 10am
 - Does Inn apparently has GF food (caprese salad, maybe fish and chips) but it looks like a 10 mile bike ride from boat place

- Beastie Boats: need to book here: <https://beastieboats.com/tour/rib-tour-dochgarroch-inverness/>
 - Have options at 9:30am, 11:30am, 2pm, and 4pm
 - Cannot rent a bike if doing 9:30am
 - 80 minutes long
- Dinner at the Kitchen at 6:30 - have a reservation but its \$12 to cancel without 24 hrs notice
- Euros 2024 FINAL! 8pm!!! Places to watch:
 - Rose Street Foundry
 - Innes Bar
 - Castle Tavern
 - Chieftain Hotel
 - The Keg

Monday, 7/15: Inverness > Edinburgh

- Train from Inverness to Edinburgh at 10:56am
 - Arrives at Edinburgh Waverly Station at 4:24pm with 1 change in Aberdeen for 50 min
 - Ticket booked
- Check-in to hotel: Kimpton Charlotte Square
- Walk along the Royal Mile
- Dinner - have reservations for the bar at Noto at 8pm
 - 24hr cancellation or else they charge \$50

Tuesday, 7/16: Edinburgh

- Climb Arthur's Seat
- Breakfast at Greenwoods
- Edinburgh Castle
- Lunch at Tupiniquim: sweet & savory 100% GF crepe cart open from 12-6
- Royal Mile, other stuff? Little dog statue? Gin Distillery Tour?
- Dinner - made a reservation at the bar at Tipo at 6:30pm - it's \$50 to cancel with less than 24 hrs notice

Wednesday, 7/17:

- Long run in the morning?
 - Park run or beach run
- Booked and paid for a Ishga Invigorating Massage at 11:10am
 - Go early and use the workout room + pool, steam room, and sauna
- Lunch at GF Cafe open from 10-3pm
- Bellfield Brewery - completely GF brewery...not open on Mon or Tues. Open Wed from 2:30-10pm
- Dinner at Lyla at 7pm
 - <https://lylaedinburgh.co.uk/> or Aizle

- Booked a reservation with cc - must cancel 72 hrs in advance. Told them GF pescatarian.
- 10 course tasting menu (optional wine pairings)
- “Guests will be invited to start their evening in our drawing room which will offer a concise list of apéritifs & our champagne trolley featuring Krug Champagne and a selection of small grower selections. You will then be served a few snacks to start the evening, sat at our chefs table chatting about the evening ahead, with views of Edinburgh city. Our evening will continue back down on the ground floor, to start our 10 course menu, dishes will be finished at the table whilst you watch the chefs work from the open kitchen.”

Thursday, 7/18: Edinburgh > DFW

- BA flight 7224 at 7:05am from Edinburgh to Heathrow
 - Arrives 8:35am
- AA flight 21 at 10:30am from LHR > DFW
 - Arrives at 2:25pm

Friday, 7/19: WORK ☹